



Office of Graduate Admissions for the College
of Education and Communication Office
Manager Standard Operating Procedures for
Phones and Mailings

Version 1.0

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Introduction

The purpose of this standard operating procedures (SOP) document is to educate readers on the general duties that the Office Manager does in their day-to-day operations related to the office phone and mailing to ensure that DePaul University's Office of Graduate Admission for the College of Education (COE) and College of Communication (CMN) runs smoothly.

This SOP serves as the one stop shop for the following office processes related to the phone and mail processing in sections detailing:

- *[What Should the Voicemail Say?](#)*
- *[How to Set Up the Voicemail](#)*
- *[How to Unset the Voicemail](#)*
- *[How to Send Documents to the DePaul University Loop Campus](#)*
- *[Processing Documents into Slate: Letters of Recommendations and Transcripts](#)*
- *[Confirming the Arrival of a LOR Sent by a Recommender or a Prospective Student](#)*
- *[How to Process and Upload Transcripts into Slate](#)*

Office Phone

As the Office of Graduate Admissions for DePaul University's COE and CMN, one of the main ways to contact the office is through the office phone. The phone number for the Office of Graduate Admission for the COE and CMN offices is 1-773-325-7315.

The Officer Manager is responsible for turning the office phones on and off every business day between the hours of 9am-5pm (CT) (barring any university holidays or when the office is closed). Outside of these hours and holidays, an automated voicemail will need to be turned on letting callers know that the office is closed and how to leave a voicemail.

Voicemails

One of the responsibilities of the Office Manager is to set up voicemail messages on the office phones in anticipation of holidays and other days that the office is closed. These closed days are determined by DePaul University and can be found on [DePaul University's Academic Calendar](#).

What Should the Voicemail Say?

The voicemail should thank the caller for contacting the office, notifying them that they have called during a time when the office is closed and include instructions on what to say if they want to leave a voicemail. An example of a holiday message is as follows:

“Thank you for calling DePaul University’s Office of Graduate Admission for the College of Education and Communication. DePaul University will be closed in observance of [insert holiday name here]. Our offices will be open again on [insert date that office will open back up]. In the meantime, please feel free to leave us a voicemail and we will contact you as soon as we can.”

Setting and Unsetting the Voicemail

How to Set Up the Voicemail Message

On the day prior to an office closure (ideally within the last 5 minutes of that day), the Office Manager will use the phone at their desk to set up a voicemail for the office phones. Once the Office Manager sets this message, all incoming phone calls will be redirected to this voicemail. This process is as follows:

1. As this process can only be set by the Office Manager’s phone, head over to the Office Manager’s desk.
2. Remove the phone from the receiver.
3. Dial “26245.”
4. Enter the “54405” extension.
5. Enter in the “123456#” pin.
6. Speaking into the phone, say “Personal Option.”
7. Press “2.”
8. Record the voicemail message.
9. The voicemail will repeat to allow the Office Manager a chance to listen to the potential voicemail message.
10. Depending on whether or not this voicemail is satisfactory:
 - a. If this voicemail is satisfactory, select “1” to confirm this as the new voicemail.
 - b. If this voicemail needs to be rerecorded, select “2” to record the message again and follow the steps above until the voicemail message is satisfactory.

How to Unset the Voicemail

Now that the offices are back open, the Office Manager will need to unset the voicemail so the office can start receiving phone calls and addressing voicemail messages left when the office was closed. The steps are as follows:

1. As this process can only be unset by the Office Manager's phone, head over to the Office Manager's desk.
2. Remove the phone from the receiver.
3. Dial "26245."
4. Enter the "54405" extension.
5. Enter in the "123456#" pin.
6. Speaking into the phone, say "Personal Option."
7. Press "2."
8. Press "1."

Mail

Another duty of the Office Manager is to manage and if needed, process incoming mail into the Slate system for prospective students as they are the only person in the office that can scan documents into the Slate system.

All mail meant for this office should be addressed to the Office of Graduate Admissions for the College of Education or to the Office of Graduate Admissions for the College of Communication at 2400 N Sheffield Ave, Chicago IL 60614. Mail sent to DePaul University's Lincoln Park campus will arrive at the university's Lincoln Park Campus Printing and Mailing department who then sorts and delivers mail to offices every Monday-Friday (excluding holidays and weekends).

Typically, the incoming morning/afternoon mail is dropped off by the Printing and Mailing department anytime between 10:30am-2:00pm. They will drop off mail for our offices into the COE and CMN "Incoming" mailbox and if there is any mail that needs to be sent from our offices, they will also pick up mail in the COE and CMN "Outgoing" mailbox.

Once that mail has arrived, the Graduate Admissions Assistants (GAA) will open the mail, sort through the mail, stamp any documents and drop documents off to the Office Manager that need to be scanned so the Office Manager can process prospective student application materials into their online portal.

How to Send Documents to the DePaul University Loop Campus

In the event that the Printing and Mailing department mistakenly drops off mail for a DePaul University's office located in the Loop campus, the Office Manager will need to follow the below process:

1. Determine the department where the mail was supposed to be dropped off at.
 - a. This could involve opening up the mail to determine what it is in regards to.
 - i. If the opened mail is related to an official transcript for a prospective student's application, include a note stating who opened the mail and the date/time as official transcripts cannot be opened by anyone other than the admissions department.
2. Grab a large yellow clasp envelope and insert the mail that should be sent to the Loop campus into the envelope.
 - a. These envelopes are used internally within DePaul University's offices to send mail back and forth to different departments.
3. On the envelope, grab a pen and cross out the last entry for "To" and "From" so as not to confuse the Printing and Mailing department when they sort through the mail.
4. In the "From" entry, enter either "Office of Graduate Admissions COE/CMN."
5. In the "To" entry, enter the name of the office where the mail was originally supposed to go to and their address.
 - a. The address can be found in the DePaul University Office Directory.
6. Drop this envelope off in the "Outgoing" mailbox.
 - a. If this is urgent mail, the Office Manager may send a GAA to deliver this mail directly to the Loop campus.

Processing Documents into Slate: Letters of Recommendations and Transcripts

The only employees who have direct access to upload and store documents into Slate are the Office Manager, Director and Assistant Directors. The Director and Assistant Director should only be involved in processing documents into Slate if the Office Manager is out of the office. GAA's and interns will only have the ability to view documents once they've been scanned into the Slate system.

In applying for graduate school in the COE and CMN, prospective students are asked for a variety of documents that must be scanned into the Slate system formally. The documents are:

- Letters of Recommendation (LOR)
 - Reference the [About Letters of Recommendations](#) section of this document for more information on LORS.
- Transcripts
 - Reference the [About Transcripts](#) section of this document for instructions for more information on transcripts.

It is important to note that not all prospective students will be required to submit these documents. That is largely dependent on each prospective student's situation and the program(s) they are applying for.

About Letters of Recommendations

LOR are letters written by someone who can attest to an individual's work or academic performance, describing a person's qualifications and skills. They should be detailed and indicate how long and under what circumstances the recommender has known the prospective student (i.e., student, assistant, advisee, employee, etc.). A recommendation is most helpful when it provides specific information concerning a prospective student's intellectual and personal characteristics and performance; it should relate to their suitability for graduate study beyond information that is available on college transcripts and employment records.”¹

Confirming the Arrival of a LOR Sent by a Recommender or a Prospective Student

1. Once a recommender or prospective student has sent a LOR through the mail and it has arrived at the office, the GAA will sort and stamp the piece of mail. This stamp will note the prospective student's Slate ID and the date it was received.
2. The GAA will drop the LOR onto the desk of the Office Manager who can begin the process to scan this document.
3. The Office Manager will need to send a “Letter of Recommendation Received at DePaul University” email to the prospective student (reference **Figure 1** below).

¹ DePaul University. (n.d.). *Guidelines for Letters of Recommendation*. Guidelines for Letters of Recommendation | Admission Requirements | Graduate Admission | Admission & Aid | College of Education | DePaul University, Chicago. Retrieved from <https://education.depaul.edu/admission-and-aid/graduate-admission/admission-requirements/Pages/letter-of-recommendation.aspx>

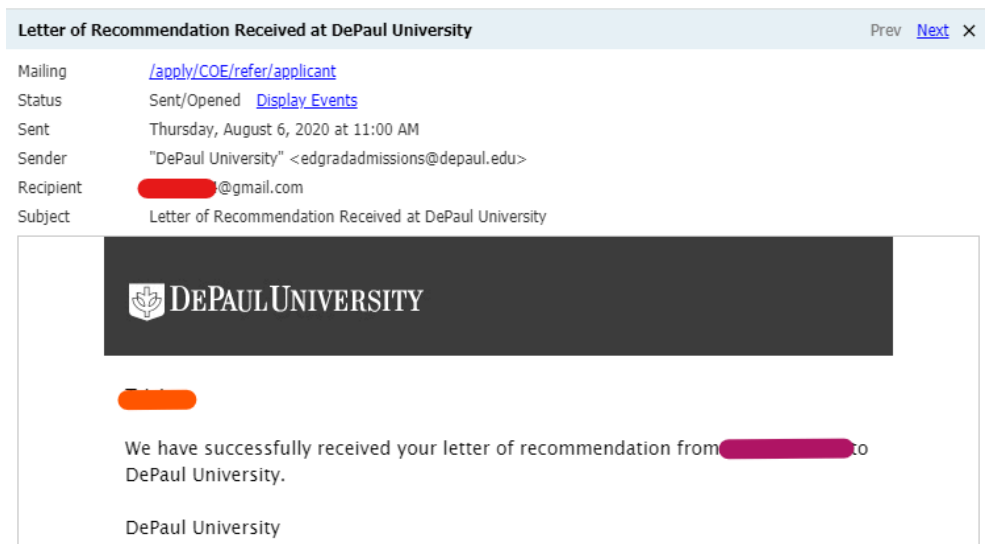


Figure 1: Letter of Recommendation Email from DePaul University

4. If the recommender has provided their contact information prior to submitting their LOR, they will receive an additional email confirming the arrival of the LOR and thanking them for writing an LOR for a prospective student.

How to Process an LOR Sent by a Student or Recommendor via Mail

1. Once confirmation emails have been sent to the prospective student and/or the recommender, the Office Manager will need to scan the LOR into the Slate system.
2. Using their printer, they will scan the letter and save it onto the computer.
3. Login to Slate and navigate to the prospective student's profile.
4. On the top of their prospective profile, locate and select the gear icon (also known as "Database").
 - a. Reference **Figure 2** below for this icon.

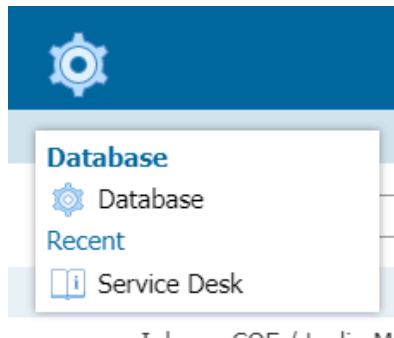


Figure 2: Database Icon

5. Scroll down to “Import” and select “Batch Acquire.”
 - a. Reference. **Figure 3** below.



Figure 3: Import Batch Acquire

6. Select the “Upload Digital Document” option and attach the downloaded/scanned LOR that was saved onto the computer.
 - a. Reference **Figure 4** below for a view of this option.

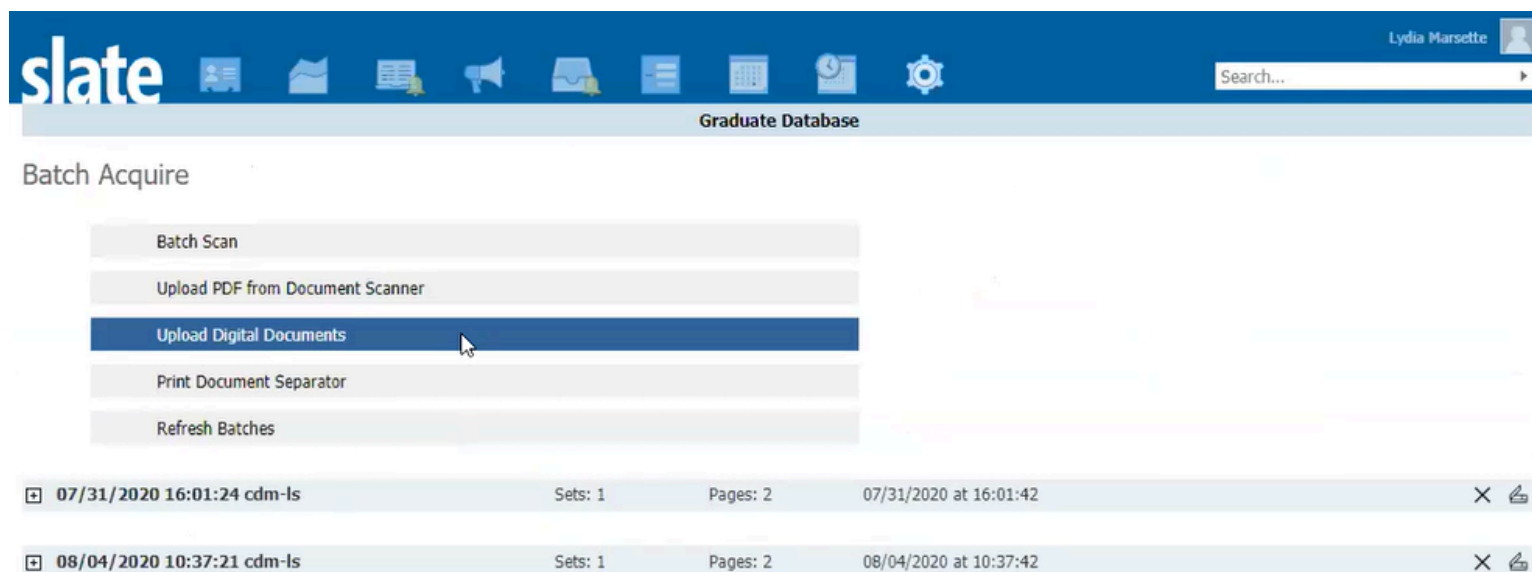


Figure 4: Upload Digital Document Feature

7. Each document should follow the same naming convention of “Upload MM/DD/YYYY HOUR-MINUTE College Initials of the Office Manager Who Uploaded the Document.”
 - a. For example: If a document was uploaded to Slate on 08/04/2026, the prospective student is applying to a COE program and the Office Manager’s name is “Jane Doe” this document should be called: “08/04/2026 11-27 COE/JD”.
 - i. This naming convention notes who uploaded the document, should there be any questions surrounding the upload.

8. Select “Upload” and it will be saved into the prospective student’s profile.
9. If the student has already started an application and an LOR is required, the Office Manager will need to assign this LOR to the prospective student’s application so their checklist reflects that the office has received this document. On this page, select the uploaded LOR (reference **Figure 5** below).

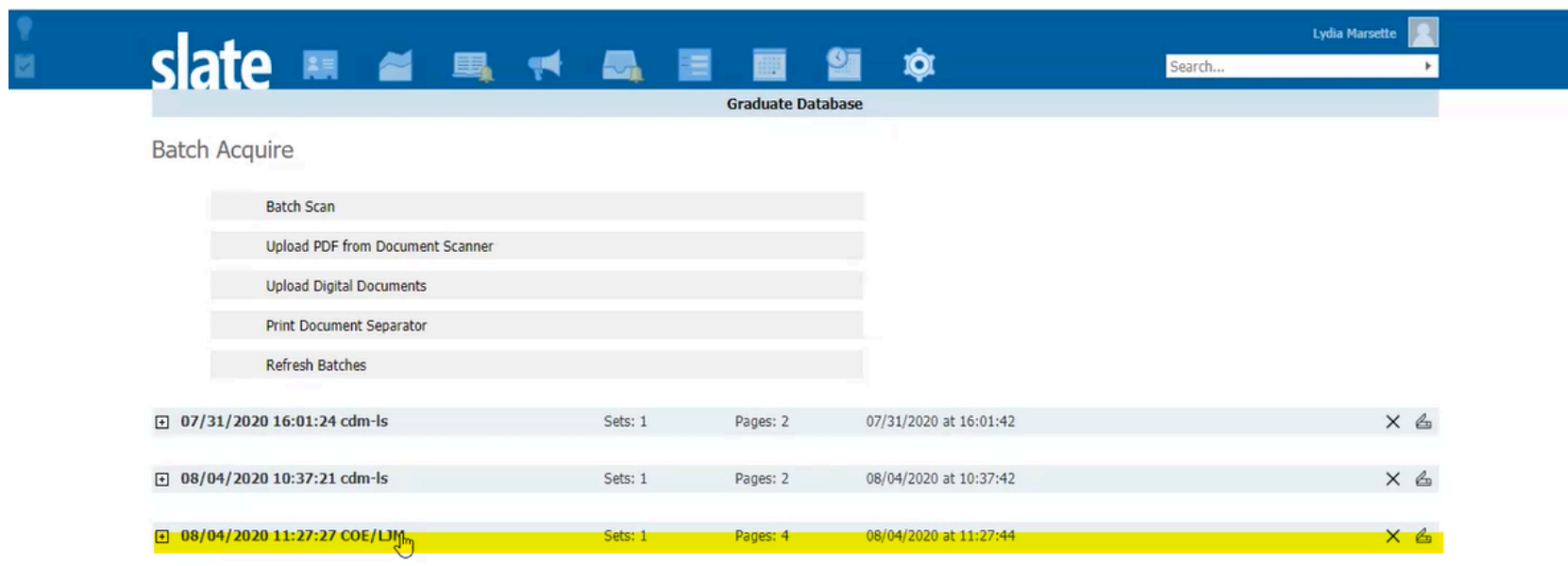


Figure 5: Uploading LOR into Slate - Uploaded Document

10. A pop up will load where the Office Manager will enter the prospective student’s first and last name in the “Assign to” field.
11. Underneath that field, change the “Material” dropdown bar to find the name of the Recommender under “References”.

- a. Reference **Figure 6** below as an example where a prospective student named “Angela” has three recommenders listed. This is because Angela had listed in her application who would be submitting LOR’s for her application. If this LOR is from Barry, select “2021 COE - Barry”, noting that the LOR from Barry should be attached to her College of Education application related to a program starting in 2021.

The screenshot shows a web interface for assigning documents. At the top, there are five buttons: Save, Delete, Back, Next, and Exit. Below these, the 'Acquired' date is 08/04/2020 at 11:27:44 AM, and the 'Pages' are 4. The 'Scope' is set to 'Folio/Application'. The 'Assign To' field shows a redacted name followed by 'Angela'. Below this are links for 'Create Record' and 'Clear'. The 'Material' dropdown menu is open, showing '2021 COE - Awaiting Materials' as the selected item. Below the dropdown, there is a list of references: '2021 COE - Awaiting Materials', 'Record Folio', and 'References'. Under 'References', there are three items: '2021 COE - Barry' (with a redacted name), '2021 COE - Sammi' (with a redacted name), and '2021 COE - Kelly' (with a redacted name). At the bottom left, there is a 'Metadata' tab.

Figure 6: Assigning Documents After Slate Upload

12. Select “Save” at the top of the screen.
13. Back on the “Batch Acquire” page, select “Refresh Batches.”
14. Now that the batch has been refreshed, the prospective student will have this document checked off on their checklist.

About Official vs. Unofficial Transcripts

Another requirement for application is transcripts from previously attended colleges and universities, classified as either official or unofficial transcripts. This includes transcripts from colleges and universities where the prospective student did not receive a degree.

Official transcripts are those that come directly from colleges and universities and ones that have not been opened by the prospective student. Prospective students can request that their previously attended colleges and universities register offices send over transcripts via mail to our offices.

If a prospective student has reached out to their previously attended college and university for their official transcript and opened the official transcript before sending it to our offices, that is considered to be an unofficial transcript. The moment transcripts are opened by a prospective student, is when it becomes an unofficial transcript and should not be scanned into the Slate system.

How to Process and Upload Transcripts into Slate

1. Once a transcript has arrived at the office, the GAA will sort and stamp the piece of mail. This stamp will note the prospective student's Slate ID and the date it was received.
2. The GAA will drop the transcript onto the desk of the Office Manager who can begin the process to scan this document.
3. Using the printer, the Office Manager will scan the transcript and save it onto their computer.
4. Login to Slate and navigate to a prospective student's Slate profile.
5. At the top of the prospective student's profile, locate and select the gear icon (also known as "Database").
 - a. Reference **Figure 7** below for this icon.

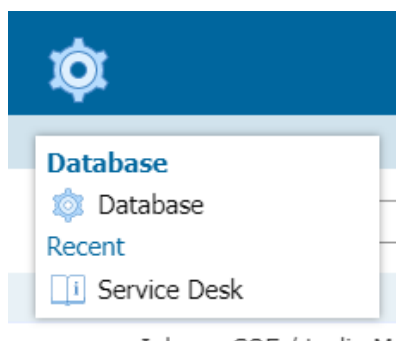


Figure 7: Database Icon

6. Scroll down to "Import" and select "Batch Acquire."
 - a. Reference **Figure 8** below for this option.



Figure 8: Import Batch Acquire

7. Select “Upload Digital Document” and attach the scanned transcript.
 - a. Reference **Figure 9** below for the Batch Acquire page.

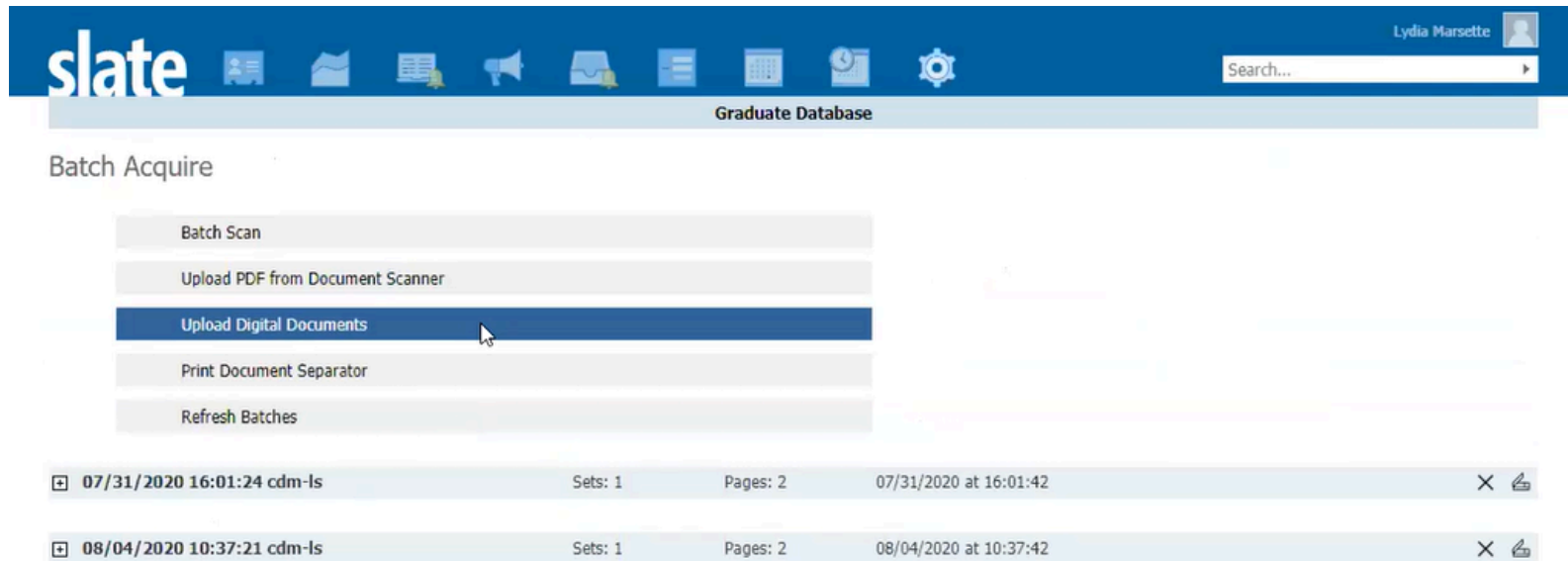


Figure 9: Upload Digital Document Feature

8. Each document should follow the same naming convention of “Upload MM/DD/YYYY HOUR-MINUTE College Initials of the Office Manager Who Uploaded the Document.”
 - a. For example: If a document was uploaded to Slate on 08/04/2026, the prospective student is applying to a COE program and the Office Manager’s name is “Jane Doe” this document should be called: “08/04/2026 11-27 COE/JD”.
 - i. This naming convention notes who uploaded the document, should there be any questions surrounding the upload.
9. Select “Upload” and it will be saved into the prospective student’s profile

10. Now that it has been uploaded, assign this transcript to the prospective student's application so their checklist reflects that we received this document. On this page, select the uploaded transcript.
- a. Reference **Figure 10** below.

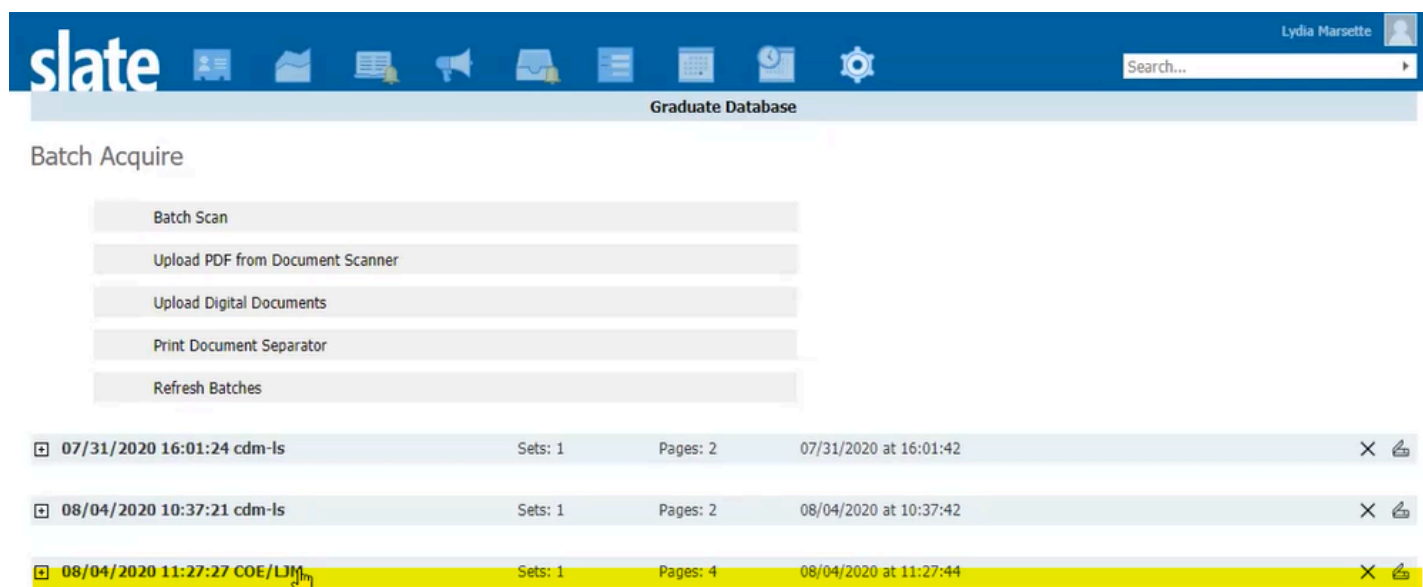


Figure 10: Uploading Transcript into Slate - Uploaded Document

11. This will load a new pop up. Change the “Material” dropdown bars to denote the institution the transcript belongs to and select the “Transcript (Official)” options.
- a. Reference **Figure 11** below.

Save Delete Back Next Exit

Acquired 08/04/2020 at 11:27:44 AM

Pages 4

Scope Folio/Application

Assign To Angela

Create Record Clear

Material Inver Hills Community College

Transcript (Official)

Figure 11: Uploading Transcript into Slate - Naming Conventions

12. Select "Save" at the top of the screen.
13. Back on the "Batch Acquire" page, select "Refresh Batches."
 - a. Reference **Figure 12** for a view on how the page should look.

slate



Lydia Marselle

Search...

Graduate Database

Batch Acquire

Batch Scan

Upload PDF from Document Scanner

Upload Digital Documents

Print Document Separator

Refresh Batches

07/31/2020 16:01:24 cdm-ls	Sets: 1	Pages: 2	07/31/2020 at 16:01:42	X	📄
08/04/2020 10:37:21 cdm-ls	Sets: 1	Pages: 2	08/04/2020 at 10:37:42	X	📄

Figure 12: Batch Acquire - Refresh Batch

Document History

Table 1: Document History Details

Date	Details	Author
02/06/2026	Creation of this document.	Technical Writer